

investing decisions, you become a better, more confident, and more successful investor.

Don't get me wrong, I'm not saying that you need to become the Queen Bee of Wall Street or take on a side gig as an investment banker in order to invest successfully. What I'm saying is that it's important for you to know what things mean and how things work so that when you put your money in the stock market, you have a good sense of what's happening and how to plan accordingly in line with your financial goals.

Look at it this way: when you purchase a car, you don't really need to know the details of what parts make up the engine, the mechanics of how the seat is designed to recline and move forward, or the science behind how the air-conditioning turns hot air from the outside into cold air on the inside based on the temperature you've set. (If you have an interest in learning how all of that works, that's great, and hey, why not? I'm just saying you can still drive the car either way.)

But what you definitely need to know, at a minimum, is how to turn the car on, how to put gas in it, how to adjust your seat and mirrors, how to drive it (and parallel-park it), and what the traffic rules are depending on where you live. You don't have to know it all; you just have to know enough to get you successfully to your destination. The bottom line is that with most things you do in life, you are going to need to have a bit of knowledge in your back pocket (or Chanel handbag—book #1 readers, you know the backstory!) to make smart decisions.

Before you can automate your investing with your robo-advisor tool, you'll need to input key information so its complex algorithms can come up with an investing strategy for you. But more importantly, you'll also need to understand the strategy it presents to a point where you have a degree of comfort and confidence about how it's going to invest your money and what could potentially happen to it.

The same applies to working with a financial advisor. Before you have your financial advisor go off and create a plan for you, you'll need to have a conversation or a series of conversations with them. And you want your side of those conversations to clearly convey your goals and objectives. You also want to be able to comprehend your advisor's side of the conversation